

# Module 07: Communication — Family Talk

## Learning Objectives

1. Understand that **Communication** is sharing what is in your brain with someone else.
2. Learn about **Listening** (The most important part!).
3. Know that we need to clear the "Noise" to be heard.

## Introduction: The Walkie-Talkies

Imagine your brain is a walkie-talkie. You want to send a thought to Mom. You press the button (Talk). "I am hungry." Mom receives the message (Listen). "Okay, let's eat." This is **Communication**. But what if there is static? (Yelling, TV on, Not looking). The message gets lost!

## Key Concepts

### 1. Sending (The Speaker)

To be a good sender:

- Use words (not just whines).
- Look at the person.
- Say what you mean ("I am sad" instead of slamming a door).

### 2. Receiving (The Listener)

To be a good receiver:

- Stop what you are doing.
- Look at the speaker.
- Listen to understand (Don't just wait to talk). "Active Listening" means acting like a satellite dish!

### 3. Noise (The Static)

Noise blocks the message.

- **Outside Noise:** TV, Tablets, Other people talking.
- **Inside Noise:** Being angry, being hungry, not paying attention. To connect, we must turn down the noise.

## Activities

### Activity 1: The Drawing Duet

Sit back-to-back with a partner. One person has a picture. The other has blank paper. The Speaker must describe the picture *without naming it*.

- "Draw a big circle."
- "Put two triangles on top."
- "Put a dot in the middle." Compare the drawings. Did the message get through?

### Activity 2: The Talking Stick

Find a special stick (or spoon). Only the person holding the stick can talk. Everyone else must listen. Pass the stick around at dinner. This helps take turns and stops "interrupting noise."

## Summary

Communication is the bridge between our islands. When we speak clearly and listen with our whole bodies, we build a bridge strong enough for love and understanding to cross.

## References

- *The Rabbit Listened* by Cori Doerrfeld
- *My Mouth is a Volcano* by Julia Cook